

INTEGRITY ATTITUDES

All the Employees and Journalists of our Company have always been expected to follow accepted norms of responsible journalism and management. Following is part of the Code of professional ethics, devised for all Employees and Journalists of The Times Group of Publications. These should give a clear understanding of the conduct expected of you during your tenure with the Company.

1. All Intellectual Property Rights relating to the work done or created by the Employees and Journalists during the period of their Contract/ Appointment including all literary, dramatic or artistic work done in the course of their contract / appointment rests with the Company solely and exclusively in perpetuity and the Company shall have the exclusive right to utilize any such material including text, photographs, illustrations, graphics, film, articles, stories, features, cartoons, books, audio, video, logos, brand names, other items, etc. created, written, made or given by the Employees and Journalists. The right in these works that are created, written or made shall continue to vest with the Company even after the termination/discontinuation or end of the contract period/ appointment.
2. The entire assignment in the Copyright for work done by Employees and Journalists during the period of the Appointment / Contract would vest with the Company and upon such assignment the concerned Employee and Journalist would not be entitled to any residual copyright in the same. The Company would have all exclusive and universal right to republish, resell or reuse in any newspaper, magazine in any language or in any medium (print, publishing, electronics, TV, Radio, Internet, digital, web etc.) the articles, stories, features, cartoons, photographs, illustrations, graphics, books, audio transcripts, audio and or visual work, logos, brand names, other items if written, given or created by the Employee and Journalist during the currency of the contract period/ appointment. The Company shall be free to make use of the contributions or work of the Employees and Journalists and exploit the same in any manner in any of the media whether it is portals or internet, radio, television, broadcasting or DTH and any other emerging form or media driven by technology or otherwise without any payment to the concerned Employee or Journalist. However, you shall not post any news and other related material including, but not limited to photographs of shareholders of the Company or their place of residences on such personal internet user account.
3. All intellectual property including but not limited to literary and artistic works made by Employees and Journalists during the period of contract / appointment with the Company is created solely for the purpose of the Company's business and therefore the Company shall be the first owner of copyright in these works. The Company asserts, and it is hereby agreed that all exclusive rights of the first owner to the said works in particular the right to publish and the right to reproduce the works in any publication(s) and/ or any type of media now known or hereafter developed vests in perpetuity with the Company.
4. The exclusive first ownership rights to all intellectual property made by the Employees and Journalists, during the course of their appointment / contract with the Company including but not limited to all column names, slugs, blurbs which now or later becomes synonymous with the Company and/ or its products vests in perpetuity with the Company and will survive the tenure of their appointment / contract with the Company.

5. It is clearly understood that in the event of any emergency where intellectual property created by the Employee or Journalist is sought by the government then it will be done with due written permission of the competent authority of the Company.
6. In pursuance to the above, the Company owns all IPRs in official communications made by / with Employees and Journalists in any media while performing their duties including but not limited to social media accounts or messages, emails, audio/ video recordings, Whatsapp messages or other official communications made through any electronic digital media in digital form or on devices (laptop/ mobile/ flash drive / hard disk or any other personal storage devices by whatever name called). Accordingly, during the term of this appointment / contract of Employees or Journalists or in the event of its termination, all documents / files / information / conversations specifically mentioned herein shall be retained by the Company. Any such official communication will not be permitted to be taken out of the office premises and may be deleted / altered from the personal accounts / devices at the Company's discretion. The Company may permit taking out of office only such information and/or conversations which are not proprietary to the Company or such data which is private in nature and is not arising out of your official obligations with the Company.
7. As part of training and development of the skills and faculties of Employees and Journalists, the Company will have to spend in cash and kind. During the course of this training and development as well as engagement with the Company, Employees and Journalists will come to know or possess proprietary and confidential information/ knowledge including trade secrets and the Company's confidential business, marketing and publishing strategies. The same shall not be used by them except in the interest of the Company.
8. Employees and Journalists shall disclose all their interests including investments in any companies and their relatives' interests to ensure that their reporting is unbiased and objective.
9. It is agreed between the Employees, Journalists and the Company that in the event the they terminate the Appointment / Contract with the Company or the term of the Appointment / Contract expires then in such event they will not recruit, select or influence in any way, any employee of the Company or anyone working with the Company on contract, to join them as an employee or partner or any other capacity, association.
10. The Employees and Journalists shall not borrow from or lend money (**involving any interest payout or with any commercial intent**) within the Company. The Company appreciates those who keep away from smoking and drinking and discourages all forms of substance abuse. As part of healthy living, only vegetarian food is served in Company's offices and Guest Houses. Consumption of any non-vegetarian food and any alcoholic beverage is discouraged on Company premises, and consumption of any psychotropic substance is not permitted on Company premises.
11. Employees and Journalists will work exclusively for and in the interest of the Company. They shall not divulge any secrets connected with the trade, business, process or interest of the Company (including information received by them from third parties in the course of their work as a journalist) i.e. 'Confidential Information', or part with any information to the detriment of the Company's interests.

12. Employees and Journalists should not to accept any gifts that may be offered and shall adhere strictly to the Company's policy on gifts.
13. Employees and Journalists should desist from accepting gifts, favors, concessional benefits such as loans, discounts, preferential shares and the sort from corporate bodies or other entities that they deal with in their professional capacity. Though nothing of value should be accepted, a commonsensical approach can be adopted towards accepting, say a modest box of sweets, inexpensive pens diaries, calendars and such other tokens of courtesy.
14. All invitations for sponsored trips should come to the Editor / Functional Head for nominating a representative of the newspaper. Under no circumstances should the individual Employee or Journalist accept such an invitation on his / her own. The name of the host/inviting agency and the fact of that trip was sponsored by it should be mentioned at the conclusion of subsequent articles. Given the sensitive nature of political journalism and employment with a media organization, no hospitality from an individual politician or party should be accepted. In order to preserve its independence, Company would not like its Employees and journalists to accept the hospitality of governmental or non-governmental institutions in India. In cases where, for convenience in Company or other institution need to be used, the Company will pay an amount equal to the ordinary commercial costs of similar facilities.
15. Every Employee and Journalist should ensure that professional objectivity is not influenced by personal likes, dislikes, friendship and ideologies. They should refrain from being members of Political organizations. Involvement in political activities, community affairs, demonstrations and social causes that could cause a conflict of interest with the discharge of professional duties should be avoided. The Employee or Journalist concerned should bring any situation of a potential conflict of interest (such as covering activities of a club organization of which one is a member) to the attention of the Editor/ Functional Head.
16. Reports, which might be damaging to an individual or organization, should not be carried without every effort being made to contact the affected party and obtain his / her / its views. In case no comment is available, the effort made to speak to the affected party should be reflected in the report.
17. An Employee or Journalist or executive should not use the normal requirement of protecting the confidentiality of his / her sources as cover to write unsubstantiated or sensational reports. The Employee or Journalist or executive concerned must be armed with enough information and argument to satisfy the Editor / Functional Head about the authenticity of his / her report, should the occasion for any doubt or question arise. While an Employee or Journalist or executive should make every effort to ensure objectivity and accuracy, the newspaper should publish corrections and acknowledge errors.
18. a. An Employee or Journalist (in market facing functions like; Brand Capital/ M&A/Response/OMS etc. and in ET/ETNow/TOI business desk respectively) will declare to his / her Functional Head / Editor his / her total shares Holdings/ interests in listed/unlisted Companies as per the protocols in place.

b. An Employee or Journalist who holds shares in a particular Company must inform his / Functional Head / Editor before writing a story and or article related to that Company/said industry. Trading by a journalist or executive on the basis of privileged and \or Confidential

Information is a gross violation of professional ethics.

c. Employees and Journalists (in market facing functions like Brand Capital/M&A/Response/OMS etc. and in ET/ETNow/TOI business desk respectively) must not engage in or facilitate any direct or indirect dissemination or misuse of the Confidential Information, be it for market transactions or otherwise.

d. Employees and Journalists (in market facing functions like Brand Capital/M&A/Response/OMS etc. and in ET/ETNow/TOI business desk respectively) should disclose and obtain prior approval from CEO for making investments in shares of any unlisted Company (including making of any angel funding/venture funding etc.). Employees shall not permit their names to be used, either directly or indirectly, by such investee companies without prior approval as stated above.

e. Specified employees to declare, as per the protocols in place, from time to time, their dealings in listed securities, unlisted securities, real estate etc., if they are working /worked on any story/article on the said entity in the case of Journalists. If any Brand Capital or Response executive have dealt with or are also dealing with an entity as a client, they should reclude themselves from investments in such entities, and if they decide to proceed with such investment, the same may only be effected with prior approval from CEO. Response and other market facing executives should also transparently disclose to their reporting managers any conflicts of interest while working on any advertisement deals.

f. Employees should avoid conducting business of the Company with a close relative or with a business in which a relative is associated in any significant role. The employment of relatives in the same department or in positions that have a financial dependence or influence is discouraged and an exemption must be obtained from CEO. The term "Relative" shall have the same meaning defined in the Companies Act, 2013.

Note: Employees of the Company to include, the immediate family, friends, associates or any family trusts or other investment vehicle if the relevant investment is established to have been influenced by the executive concerned.

g. The Company strives to maintain a healthy work environment which is free from any undue influence or harassment, where employees can perform effectively and achieve their full potential. As you and your colleagues spend considerable time together at the workplace, some of you may develop personal, intimate, romantic or physical relationships. When workplace relationships present a conflict of interest with the Company's objectives, they evoke deep concern. Any such workplace relationships which may jeopardize efficiency, security, morale or supervisory frameworks are accordingly strongly discouraged by the Company.

You shall not directly or indirectly supervise any colleague if you develop any personal, intimate, romantic or physical relationship with such colleague - even if it is brief or casual. This requirement shall be applicable even when you are NOT in a position to influence such colleague's work profile.

If you develop any personal, intimate, romantic or physical relationship at the workplace, or have or develop a family relationship with a colleague, you shall immediately disclose such relationships to the HR department of the Company through a communication sent

to the email: personalrelationships@timesofindia.com within 15 days (of forming such a relationship). The matter will be kept confidential and suitable advice / instruction shall be shared with you in accordance with the Company's policies.

Notwithstanding the above, if any complaint is made against a person (making such disclosure) under any of the Company's policies - including the policy on Prevention, Deterrence and Redressal of Sexual Harassment at the Workplace - the Company may, at its discretion, take suitable and appropriate action in accordance with the applicable policies and provisions of law

19. An Employee or Journalist of the Company should not acquire flats/house/land at concessional rate courtesy any government quota. In case there are any who have already acquired such property out of such a quota, they should declare to the Company the acquisition along with the price paid. Accredited journalists occupying government accommodation on rent should confirm to the newly announced guidelines of the press Council of India in this regard: payment by the employer, declaration to the government on March 31 of every year of details regarding salary, property acquired etc.: vacation of accommodation on expiry of allotment, etc. Information on all these aspects should be declared to the Functional Head / Editor.
20. An advisory committee of Employees and Journalists selected by the Functional Head / Editor will be set up to inquire into complaints of misdemeanor or bias against any Employee or Journalist. The committee may call upon the Employee or Journalist in question to submit a list of his/her assets or a record of his/her investments or any relevant document should the need arise. The Functional Head/Editor will carefully consider the committee's recommendations before taking any action.
21. Employees and Journalists in the Company are likely to be pampered, mollicoddled and felicitated by the government and other organs of state or sections of the civil society for their PR. The same should not be expected from the Company as the relationship with the Company is strictly employer-employee. When senior members of the government including ministers visit Employees and Journalists on ritualistic occasions such as anniversaries, birthdays, etc. for their PR purpose, the concerned employee being in employment of a high visibility leader media organization will not look forward to the same from the Company.
22. Likewise, other organs of the State, including, government or institutions may propitiate Employees and Journalists to do specialized writings on the plea that only they can do such a specialized writing on laudable subjects such as military, national integration etc. In such case, Employees and Journalists should be aware that when they take up such assignments it is in deviation and conflict with their relationship with the Company. If ever they are permitted to make such a contribution for the nation, it will then obviously, be the contribution of the Company, and they will be duty bound to project and represent so that the Company gets due acknowledgement.
23. Employees and Journalists are involved in the processing of news and handling of events of importance to people involving public or special celebrity groups. They thus occupy a position of importance to these groups which will obviously make reverential gestures to them for their PR need. They will not expect the same from the Company.

24. The Company has often welcomed former Employees and Journalists back for work, and it is a matter of record that people have left and returned. The Company has often been involved in India's most coveted events. This being so, it has never felt the need to hold farewell events which, obviously, have no rationale or appeal given the Company's engagement in mega events which are sponsored as well as entertaining. People in the Company have little or no time to attend such ritualistic farewell events. Moreover, joining such farewell parties either by Directors or senior members of the organization is, indeed, not tenable given the choice to attend so many mega events of the Company as part of their duty or otherwise.
25. Employees and Journalists should respect protocols and culture of the organization as different from that of other organizations. The Company does not encourage practices, designations etc. followed by other organizations. It does not want any practices/appurtenances from the other organizations. That is why it does not allow security guards saluting to its staff (Government/Military/Police) or bowing by the staff as applicable in other states (law). Its appreciation is more based on contribution and talent than bowing and saluting. It does not encourage over courtesies and under courtesies because the same delays the process. The Company's courtesies and protocols are meant to expedite the transactions. People who perform over courtesies tend to cause divisiveness in the organization.
26. Journalists being in the vanguard of journalism would often be cajoled to write on the basis of sentiment about the nation, military, state etc. and journalists should be aware that such appeals are stock appeals and should not in any manner distract them from their basic and core duty to the Company. They may also be appealed to write speeches to leaders on such similar grounds including propitiating their ego as being the best writer or intellectual. This also should not detract them from their basic and core duty to the Company. Journalists should not expect the same felicitation and praise from the Company's internal system because their relationship with the outside world is different from their relationship with the Company.
27. Employees shall work exclusively for and in the interest of the Company and should not engage in any part-time work or engage in any other work, business, occupation of consultation of any kind or accept any employment whether free or paid, directly or indirectly in any other media Company including newspaper, magazine, internet, television, radio or any other form of media engaged in dissemination of content. Journalists shall strive to work exclusively for and in the interest of the Company and should not engage in any part-time work or engage in any other work, business, occupation of consultation of any kind or accept any employment whether free or paid, directly or indirectly in any other media Company including newspaper, magazine, internet, television, radio or any other form of media engaged in dissemination of content without prior written information to the Company. Likewise, they should not accept any invitation, whether honorary or paid, to appear on television or on radio.
28. As Journalists with a high-visibility news organization, our editorial colleagues are routinely invited to speak at events, moderate panels, host discussions, participate on shows on television, radio or podcasts, and so on. All such engagements are to be accepted only with the documented approval of the Executive Editor. The Executive Editor will use his/her judgment before permitting such engagements keeping in mind conflict of interest and perception of bias or favor by our organization towards external entities.
29. Employees and Journalists shall hold themselves in readiness for any transfers training at any place or places whenever required.